Afaq Ahmed

Experienced Data Engineer

Espoo, Finland
+358417235431
iafaqhere1@gmail.com
LinkedIn

Quick Summary

Dedicated and results-driven analytics professional with experience in the Education, construction, and Retail industries, seeking a role to leverage analytical skills and contribute to the organization's growth and success by developing pipelines and insightful reporting.

Skillset

Technical Skills: Data Engineer (4 years of project experience), Python/PySpark, SQL, ETL/ELT, Dimensional Data Modeling, dbt, Microsoft Fabric, Databricks, Apache Spark, Azure Data Factory, Apache Airflow, Medallion Architecture, PowerBI, Tableau, CI/CD, Docker, GIT, Azure DevOps, Agile Methodology

Professional Experience

Nov'23 - Mar'25

Hybrid • Joensuu, Finland

University of Eastern Finland Visit Site

Research Fellow Assistant - Data Engineer

- Developed and orchestrated ETL/ELT pipelines using Python, PySpark, SQL, to ingest and transform student enrollment, academic performance, and feedback data (5M+ records), reducing manual processing time by 60%.
- Designed and implemented a dimensional data model on Warehouse, integrating student, faculty, and course data, which improved query performance by 45% and reduced report generation time from hours to minutes.
- Built interactive dashboards in Power BI to visualize retention trends, graduation rates, dropout risks, and departmental workloads, increasing data accessibility for academic staff by 70%.
- Built automated anomaly detection scripts in Python to flag unusual patterns (e.g., sudden GPA spikes, missing enrollment IDs), reducing data investigation time by 40%.
- Designed checkpointing and retry logic for long-running PySpark jobs, ensuring data consistency during pipeline restarts and minimizing downtime.

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Sep'21 — Aug'23

Hybrid • Dublin, Ireland

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Data Engineer

- Built an end-to-end ETL pipeline from Azure DevOps APIs using Python and dbt, reducing backlog analysis time by 75%.
- Delivered real-time Power BI dashboards for engineering leads and senior managers. Improved sprint planning accuracy by 25% across multiple Scrum teams.
- Engineered an end-to-end analytics solution for WayLoader using Microsoft Fabric (Data Factory, Lakehouse, Pipelines), improving data freshness by 70%, cutting manual reporting time by 50%, and boosting product sales visibility.
- Designed a real-time analytics platform on Power BI, giving stakeholders live insights into project risks, resources, and procurement, leading to a 25% faster delivery and 30% better resource utilization for construction project.

Academic Profile

2023 — 2025

Masters in Computer Science

On-site • Joensuu, Finland

University of Eastern Finland

→ Full-time On-site Masters Degree

Research Thesis: Hybrid Deep Learning Model for Diabetes Early Detection
Main Courses: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Applied Image Processing, Natural Language Processing

2017 — 2021

On-site • Islamabad, Pakistan

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

Comsats University Islamabad

→ Full-time On-site Bachelor's Degree

FYP Project: Developed a POS System with dynamic functionalities using PHP, SQL Database and carried out testing among local retailers.
Main Courses: Data Warehousing & Data Mining, Artificial Intelligence, Database Systems, Design Principles, Web & Intranet